

ANDREAS SOCHOPOULOS

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EDUCATION

The University of Edinburgh, UK

September 2023 - Present

PhD in Robot Learning (*Honda Research Institute EU funded studentship*)

Advisors: Sethu Vijayakumar (UoE), Michael Gienger (HRI-EU)

Research topic: *Fast and self-improving robot policies using diffusion and flow models for manipulation.*

Aristotle University of Thessaloniki (AUTH), Greece

September 2016 - October 2022

Diploma in Electrical and Computer Engineering (5-year degree)

Average Grade: **9.08/10** (“Excellent”, 3rd highest grade)

Advisor: Georgios Rovithakis

Thesis Title: *Prescribed performance torque control with obstacles for uncertain robot dynamics.*

EXPERIENCE

Honda Research Institute EU

September 2023 - Present

Research Collaborator

Offenbach, Germany

Joint research on imitation learning for manipulation and annual research visits for robot deployments.

University of Tokyo

June 2025 - August 2025

Visiting Researcher

Tokyo, Japan

Researched point-cloud generation using diffusion models for real-sim-real policies.

Italian Institute of Technology (IIT)

April 2022 - April 2023

Research Assistant

Genoa, Italy

Developed human activity recognition and adaptive policies for assistive robots.

CERN

February 2021 - April 2022

Software Engineer

Geneva, Switzerland

Developed and maintained production monitoring software used in the CMS detector control room.

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Teaching Assistant in Applied Machine Learning

September 2025 - Present

The University of Edinburgh

Tutor in Machine Learning and Pattern Recognition

September 2024 - January 2025

The University of Edinburgh

SELECTED PUBLICATIONS

Sochopoulos, A., Whitammer, E., Tsagkas, N., Moura, J., Gienger, M., and Vijayakumar, S. “Optimal Transport Q-Learning for Flow Policy Steering and Acceleration.” **Conference on Robot Learning (CoRL)**, 2026.

Tsagkas, N., **Sochopoulos, A.**, Danier, D., Vijayakumar, S., Lu, C. X., Mac Aodha, O., and Kouris, A. “Decoupling the Declarative from the Procedural in Vision-Language-Action Models.” arXiv preprint, 2026.

Sochopoulos, A., Malkin, N., Tsagkas, N., Moura, J., Gienger, M., and Vijayakumar, S. “Fast Flow-based Visuomotor Policies via Conditional Optimal Transport Couplings.” **Conference on Robot Learning (CoRL)**, 2025.

Tsagkas, N., **Sochopoulos, A.**, Danier, D., Vijayakumar, S., Lu, C. X., Mac Aodha, O. “Attentive Feature Aggregation or: How Policies Learn to Stop Worrying about Robustness and Attend to Task-Relevant Visual Cues.” **International Conference on Robotics and Automation (ICRA)**, 2025.

Sochopoulos, A., Gienger, M., and Vijayakumar, S. “Learning Deep Dynamical Systems Using Stable Neural ODEs.” **International Conference on Intelligent Robots and Systems (IROS)**, 2024.

AWARDS AND SCHOLARSHIPS

A.G. Leventis Foundation PhD scholarship (re-awarded)	2025
A.G. Leventis Foundation PhD scholarship	2024

SKILLS

Programming: Python, C++, C
ML & Robotics: LeRobot, ROS/ROS 2, PyTorch, JAX, MuJoCo, Isaac Sim
Robot Platforms: KUKA LBR iiwa, Kinova Gen3 , SO101
Languages: Greek (native), English (fluent), German (basic)